

Unit description

Students will develop a knowledge and understanding of the short- and long-term physiological and psychological preparations made by elite athletes.

They will consider the short- and long-term technical preparations required, eg selection of appropriate kit and equipment, the use of training camps, different types of ergonomic aids.

Assessment information

The assessment of this unit is through a 2-hour examination paper which is set and marked by Pearson.

The paper will be a question-and-answer booklet and all questions in the paper are compulsory. The paper will consist of short-answer and extended-writing type questions.

The total marks for the paper are 90.

What students need to learn

3.1 Short-term preparation

Short-term physiological preparation

Warm-up:

Stages, types of stretching, intensity, duration

Sources of energy for exercise:

Students need to understand energy systems (the ATP-PC system, Lactic and aerobic pathways and the energy continuum) and the following sources of energy for exercise:

- dietary manipulation
- carbo-loading
- hydration
- creatine loading

Short-term acclimatisation:

Environmental factors that influence preparation and competition, heat adaptation, hydration planning, increase in plasma volume, increased sweat rate, effects of altitude

Short-term psychological preparation

Motivation and stress control:

- anxiety (cognitive and somatic, state and trait)
- theories of anxiety and arousal (Drive Theory, inverted-U Hypothesis, Catastrophe Theory, zone of optimum performance)
- effects on technique, eg choking, aggression versus assertion

Strategies:

Mental rehearsal, use of visualisation and imagery, 'self talk', pre-game routines, relaxation techniques, somatic and cognitive techniques including PMR (Progressive Muscle Relaxation), control of aggression

External influences:

Home advantage, crowd effect, social facilitation, importance of competition, evaluation apprehension, strategies for coping, environmental factors